TRAINER ANSWER KEY

Lab 4 – Investigation Prompts & Expected Output

The matrix below is a model training answer. The labels describe issues to investigate, not established misconduct.

1. Potential order-splitting / threshold issue

Evidence: E2 and E3. Two ■4.9 lakh POs were approved on the same day and a ■9.8 lakh invoice references both. Status: Needs verification. Check procurement thresholds, business justification, PO creation records and whether the two requirements were genuinely separate.

2. Potential preferential treatment

Evidence: E1 and E5. E1 contains wording about sharing other rates; E5 shows CleanPro quoted ■9.8 lakh while Bidder X and Bidder Y quoted ■8.1 lakh and ■8.4 lakh. Status: Open – interview. Obtain the complete email chain, bid submissions, timestamps, evaluation records and interview relevant personnel.

3. Potential undisclosed relationship

Evidence: E4. The vendor phone number matches the emergency contact of PM-1's relative. Status: Needs verification. The match alone does not establish a relationship between PM-1 and CleanPro or any conflict of interest. Verify the vendor contact, relationship, disclosure records and relevant due-diligence information.

4. Potential process irregularity

Evidence: E2 and E3. The invoice is dated 10 Feb while the two POs are dated 14 Feb. Status: Open – check with Finance. Verify whether the dates represent invoice creation, service date, advance billing, correction or another legitimate process.

Timeline

03 Feb 2026 – E1 email. 10 Feb 2026 – E3 invoice. 14 Feb 2026 – E2 POs. Dates for E4 and E5 are not stated in the supplied case pack and should not be invented.

Trainer emphasis

The strongest teaching point is language discipline: “potential,” “indicator,” “needs verification,” and “open” are appropriate. “Proven,” “fraud,” “kickback,” or “conflict of interest” should not be presented as established conclusions from this evidence alone.